



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 10/30/2025	Entry: #1
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident
Tool(s) used	Not used
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● Who: An organized group of unethical hackers ● What: A ransomware security incident ● Where: At a health care company ● When: Tuesday at 9am ● Why: The incident originated from a phishing email containing a malicious attachment, which, once opened, triggered ransomware deployment. The attack encrypted critical system files and was accompanied by a ransom note from an organized threat actor demanding payment for the decryption key.
Additional notes	The company appears to lack adequate employee training on phishing awareness, and there is no evidence of essential security controls such as IDS/IPS, antivirus solutions, or properly configured firewalls. The absence of a backup strategy further exposes the organization to unnecessary risk. Paying attackers for a decryption key is strongly discouraged, as it does not

	guarantee data recovery and may create additional legal and security complications.
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